This challenge isn't unique to Django. Moving text files between operating systems or having an editor add a BOM when not expected can make text unreadable by any program. I've run into cases where the addition of the BOM meant Django couldn't load the fixture anymore.

Be especially careful when editing a fixture file, as the settings for your IDE may mess it up. This is complicated by the fact that some IDEs automatically open the file for you when they detect it has been created. This is more likely if you ran the `dumpdata` command inside your IDE's command window. When the IDE opens the file, it "fixes" it by adding the BOM. Using a terminal external to the IDE should provide a workaround for this problem.

This next bit can be a little nerve racking. It is time to delete your database. As the fixture stores exactly what is in the database, loading it will overwrite the content that is there. You won't see any difference. If you delete your database (or rename it, if that makes you more comfortable), you can then use the fixture to re-create it.

Deleting your database sets you to zero, though. Those migrations you ran won't exist. After deleting your database, but before loading the fixture, you need to run the `migrate` command. The following sequence removes and then restores your database from the fixture:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ rm db.sqlite3
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py migrate
Operations to perform:
  Apply all migrations: admin, auth, bands, contenttypes, sessions
Running migrations:
  Applying contenttypes.0001_initial... OK
  Applying auth.0001_initial... OK
  Applying admin.0001_initial... OK
  Applying admin.0002_logentry_remove_auto_add... OK
  Applying admin.0003_logentry_add_action_flag_choices... OK
  Applying contenttypes.0002_remove_content_type_name... OK
  Applying auth.0002_alter_permission_name_max_length... OK
  Applying auth.0003_alter_user_email_max_length... OK
  Applying auth.0004_alter_user_username_opts... OK
  Applying auth.0005_alter_user_last_login_null... OK
  Applying auth.0006_require_contenttypes_0002... OK
  Applying auth.0007_alter_validators_add_error_messages... OK
  Applying auth.0008_alter_user_username_max_length... OK
  Applying auth.0009_alter_user_last_name_max_length... OK
  Applying auth.0010_alter_group_name_max_length... OK
  Applying auth.0011_update_proxy_permissions... OK
  Applying auth.0012_alter_user_first_name_max_length... OK
  Applying bands.0001_initial... OK
  Applying bands.0002_venue_room... OK
  Applying bands.0003_band... OK
  Applying sessions.0001_initial... OK
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py loaddata bands.json
Installed 8 object(s) from 1 fixture(s)
```